

#FREELANCELYFE

In 2013, I moved to LA from New York. I was able to keep my full-time reporting job at the *Daily Dot* by working remotely and from home. After a few months in LA, I quit the *Daily Dot* and took a local job blogging for an Internet news recap show. I sometimes appeared on the show, which had some notoriety in the YouTube community. My following on social media grew again, but our boss was an unreliable weirdo who eventually fired me for, I assume, not . . . blogging enough? I went back to freelance writing for magazines and other publications like I had been in NYC, but it wasn't good money. I needed another income stream. Fast.

That's when I decided to nude-model. I thought maybe I could eventually become a Suicide Girl. Suicide Girls, named after a line in a Chuck Palahniuk book called *Survivor*, are models that have piercings or tattoos, or both, as I did at the time. I made an account on ModelMayhem, the Craigslist of modeling. The photographers are equal parts legit and creeps. Like in the actual modeling industry, I imagine, it's hard to discern who is what.

I modeled three times. Nothing untoward ever happened to me. All three male photographers I worked with were respectful, but I had no prior knowledge of how this kind of work was supposed to go and could have easily been walking right into my death. Obviously, the photos are out there and they circulate every so often. I'm not shy about my body. Luckily, I also work in an industry where my having gotten paid for nude modeling isn't a deal breaker. In fact, I modeled nude again in 2017 for an anti-slut shaming campaign for which I did not get paid but which *was* a good cause. (This is what I said to convince my manager to let me do it.)

I didn't know what to charge for nude modeling (advice sites vary from \$15 to \$60 an hour), and I took way less than I should have (around \$10 an hour). But with that and YouTube, it filled the short gap between my other jobs. I also